

IT Helpdesk Knowledge Base

Synthetic Internal Support Guide • Edition 03 • Remote Access, Accounts & Equipment

Organization: CedarPoint Logistics **Owner:** Workplace Technology

Purpose: Provide employees with clear, repeatable instructions for common IT requests and troubleshooting.

Security Notice: Never provide passwords, MFA codes, recovery codes, API keys, or authentication tokens to support staff.

1. Helpdesk Service Overview

The CedarPoint IT Helpdesk supports employee accounts, remote access, company devices, standard applications, connectivity, and security-related reports.

Service	Responsible Team	Typical Requests
Account Access	Identity Services	Password reset, account lockout, MFA
Remote Access	Network Services	VPN, remote internal resources
Devices	Endpoint Services	Laptop, monitor, accessories
Applications	Business Systems	Approved application problems
Security	Security Operations	Phishing, suspicious login, lost device

Support Channels

- IT Portal: <https://example.com/cedarpoint/help>
- IT Email: helpdesk@cedarpoint.example
- Knowledge Center: <https://example.com/cedarpoint/kb>
- Critical Support Queue: IT-CRITICAL

All links and contact details above are fictional placeholders.

2. Ticket Severity

Level	Meaning	Example	Target Response
Sev 1	Enterprise-wide outage or major security event	Corporate authentication unavailable	15 min
Sev 2	Critical work is blocked	Remote employee cannot reach required system	1 hr
Sev 3	Normal individual/team issue	VPN troubleshooting	4 business hrs
Sev 4	Routine request	Keyboard or monitor request	1 business day

3. VPN / Remote Access

Before Troubleshooting

- Confirm the device has internet access.
- Check that the approved VPN client is installed.
- Confirm the company account is active.
- Verify the device date and time are correct.
- Have the approved MFA method available.

Standard Connection Steps

- Open the CedarPoint VPN application.
- Select the Corporate Remote Access profile.
- Enter your company username.
- Complete MFA when prompted.

- Confirm the connection shows Connected.
- Open the internal resource you need.

VPN Problem Guide

Symptom	Possible Cause	Action
Invalid credentials	Incorrect password or locked account	Use account recovery; avoid repeated attempts.
MFA not arriving	Notification/network issue	Check connection and MFA device settings.
Disconnects frequently	Unstable network	Switch to a reliable connection and reconnect.
Connected but internal site fails	Routing or DNS issue	Reconnect and test another internal service.
Client fails to launch	Endpoint software issue	Restart; contact Endpoint Services if persistent.

VPN Escalation Details

When opening a ticket, include the device type, operating system, VPN client version if known, approximate failure time, whether the client says Connected, and the exact error message.

4. Password Reset

Use the self-service identity portal whenever possible. Helpdesk personnel do not need your current password to reset access.

Self-Service Procedure

- Open the CedarPoint Identity Portal.
- Select Reset Password.
- Complete identity verification.
- Create a new unique password.
- Sign in with the new password.
- Complete MFA if prompted.
- Reconnect to VPN if required.

Good Password Practices

- Use a long and unique password or approved passphrase.
- Do not reuse company passwords on external services.
- Do not send passwords through email, chat, or tickets.
- Use the approved password manager.
- Never approve an unexpected MFA request.

5. Account Lockout & MFA

Issue	First Response	Escalate To
Account locked	Stop repeated login attempts; use recovery	Identity Services
Lost MFA device	Report immediately and complete identity verification	Identity + Security
New phone	Enroll using approved process	Identity Services
MFA push missing	Check network and notification settings	Identity Services
Unexpected MFA request	Reject it and report it	Security Operations

6. Hardware Requests

Hardware is provided according to role requirements, inventory, compatibility, security standards, and approval requirements.

Item	Common Use	Information Required
Laptop	New hire/replacement	Role, location, required software, manager

Item	Common Use	Information Required
Monitor	Additional display	Desk setup and preferred size
Dock	Multi-display setup	Laptop model and display count
Headset	Calls and meetings	Role and usage
Keyboard / Mouse	Replacement or ergonomic need	Current equipment and reason
Mobile Device	Approved business work	Business justification and manager

Request Workflow

- Submit an equipment request in the IT portal.
- Select the correct equipment category.
- Explain the business need.
- Provide delivery/location information.
- Attach approval if required.
- IT checks stock and compatibility.
- IT assigns or orders the item.
- Confirm receipt and asset information.

7. Hardware Troubleshooting

Laptop Overheating or Fan Noise

- Move the device to a hard, unobstructed surface.
- Close resource-heavy applications.
- Restart the device.
- Install approved operating-system updates.
- Contact Endpoint Services if the issue continues.

Monitor Not Detected

- Confirm the monitor has power.
- Check the display cable and input source.
- Reconnect the docking station.
- Restart the laptop.
- Test the approved alternate cable or port if available.

8. Lost or Stolen Device

Report missing company equipment immediately. Delayed reporting can increase security exposure.

- Contact the IT Helpdesk immediately.
- Notify Security Operations when sensitive information may be exposed.
- Provide the asset tag or serial number if known.
- State the approximate time and location.
- Follow instructions for remote session or account protection.
- Do not attempt to recover stolen equipment yourself.

Do not wait until the next business day to report a missing company device.

9. Wi-Fi & Connectivity

Basic Checks

- Confirm Wi-Fi is enabled.
- Check whether other websites load.
- Reconnect to the approved corporate or guest network.
- Move closer to the access point when appropriate.
- Restart the device if the issue persists.

When to Escalate

- Multiple employees in the same location are affected.
- The corporate network is unavailable.
- Connectivity repeatedly drops after standard troubleshooting.
- The issue occurs across multiple devices.

10. Software & Application Support

Use company-managed software distribution for standard applications. Non-standard software requires an IT request and may require security or licensing review.

- Do not install pirated or unknown software.
- Use approved software catalogs.
- Record the exact application error.
- Note when the issue started.
- Include the application version when available.
- Do not upload confidential information to unapproved diagnostic websites.

11. Security Incident Reporting

Scenario	Immediate Action
Phishing message	Stop interaction and report it through the security workflow.
Credentials exposed	Reset the affected credential and contact Security.
Unexpected MFA request	Reject it and report it.
Lost company device	Contact IT and Security immediately.
Suspicious application	Follow Security instructions; avoid further interaction.
Suspicious login alert	Verify activity and report anything unrecognized.

12. Helpdesk Ticket Template

Subject: Concise description of the issue
Device: Laptop / Desktop / Mobile
Application or Service: Name and version if known
Expected: What should happen
Actual: What happened instead
Error: Exact message
Steps Tried: Troubleshooting already completed
Impact: Individual / Team / Business-wide
Started: Approximate date and time

13. Example Support Tickets

VPN Example

Subject: VPN connects but Warehouse Dashboard will not load
Device: Corporate Windows laptop
Expected: Dashboard opens after VPN connection
Actual: Browser times out while VPN reports Connected
Tried: Reconnected VPN and restarted laptop
Impact: Shipment processing is delayed

Hardware Example

Subject: Request for replacement docking station
Current Equipment: USB-C dock intermittently disconnects displays
Business Need: Daily dual-monitor workstation
Tried: Reconnected cables and restarted laptop
Request: Compatible replacement dock

14. Frequently Asked Questions

Can the Helpdesk reset my password for me?

Support can assist with account recovery after verifying your identity, but you should never provide your current password.

Why is VPN connected but an internal application unavailable?

A VPN connection can be established while an internal route or service is unavailable. Reconnect, test another internal resource, and provide the results in your ticket.

Can I request a second monitor?

Yes. Submit a hardware request with your desk setup and business justification. Approval requirements depend on company policy.

What should I do after receiving a suspicious MFA prompt?

Reject the request and report it to Security Operations. Do not approve a login you did not initiate.

What if I lose my laptop while traveling?

Report it immediately to IT and Security and follow the account-protection instructions you receive.

15. Escalation Matrix

Issue	Primary Team	Escalate When
Password / MFA	Identity Services	Self-service recovery fails or identity issue persists
VPN	Network Services	Multiple users affected or persistent gateway issue
Laptop / Monitor	Endpoint Services	Repeated failure or suspected hardware defect
Application	Business Applications	Approved troubleshooting does not resolve issue
Security	Security Operations	Potential credential, device, or data exposure
Hardware Request	Device Services	Non-standard equipment or inventory problem

16. Employee Quick Reference

- I know how to submit an IT ticket.
- I know how to reset my password.
- I know how to connect to the corporate VPN.
- I know where to request hardware.
- I know how to report a lost device.
- I know how to report phishing or suspicious activity.
- I know never to share my password or MFA codes.

17. Final Reminder

Protect your credentials, use approved tools, provide useful troubleshooting details, and report security incidents immediately. The Helpdesk can resolve issues faster when tickets contain clear symptoms, impact, and steps already attempted.

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